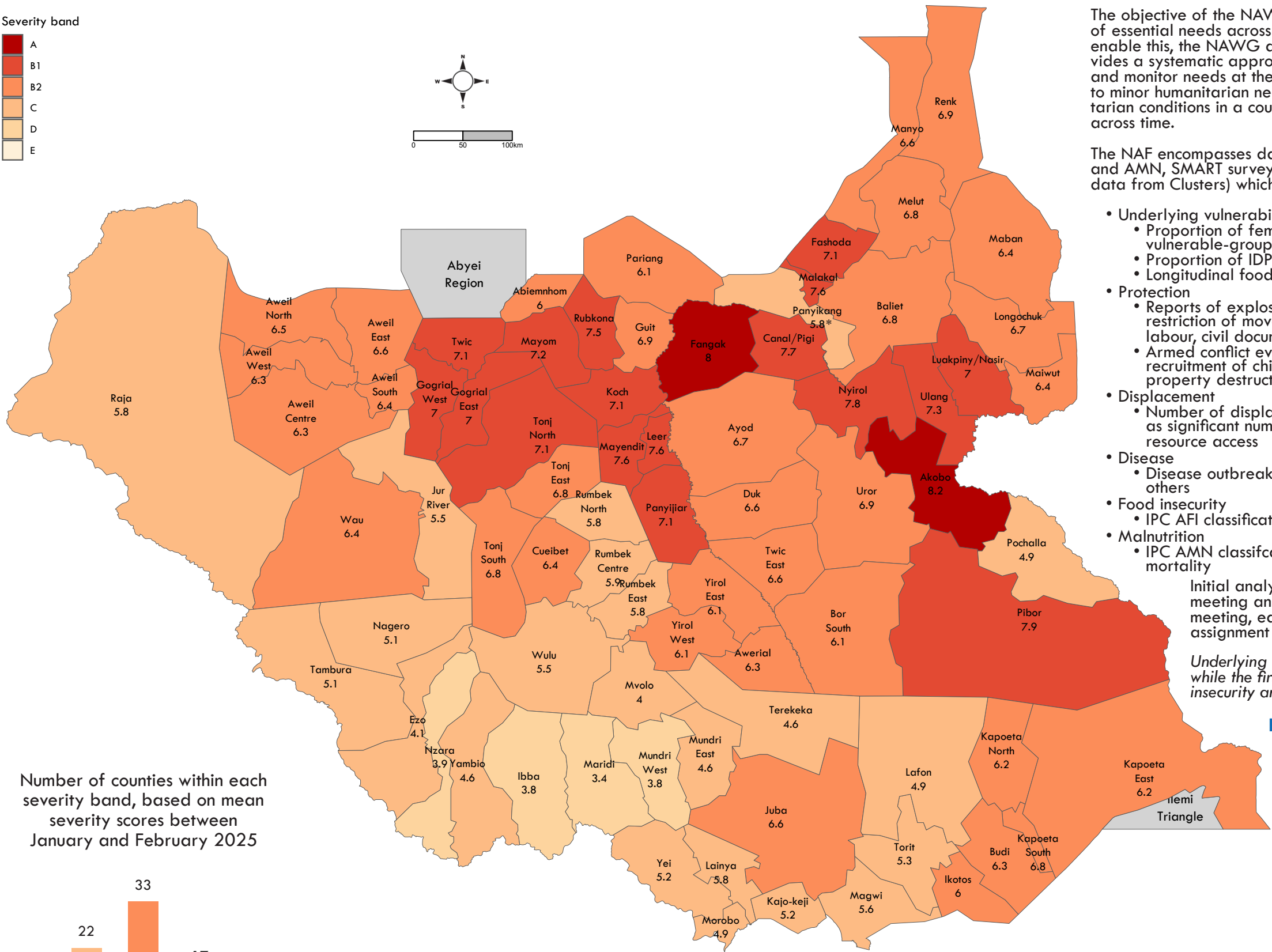
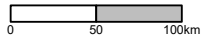


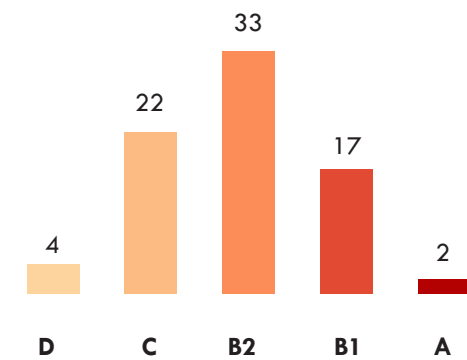
SOUTH SUDAN - NEEDS ANALYSIS WORKING GROUP (NAWG)

January 2025 - February 2025 Analysis

Severity band



Number of counties within each severity band, based on mean severity scores between January and February 2025



For more information on the Needs Analysis Working Group or the NAWG Analytical Framework, please contact Felix Omuu (omunu@un.org) or Rebecca Hetzer (rebecca.hetzer@impact-initiatives.org).

Background

The NAWG meeting was held on 30th January 2025 at the OCHA office in Juba, and was attended by REACH, OCHA, the Food Security and Livelihoods Cluster, FAO, Amani Africa, SSHF, and MedAir.

The objective of the NAWG is to conduct evidence-based and contextualized analysis of essential needs across South Sudan to inform decision-making and prioritization. To enable this, the NAWG analytical framework (NAF) was developed. The NAF provides a systematic approach to interpret a wide array of multi-sectoral information and monitor needs at the county-level. The final classification (ranging from extreme to minor humanitarian needs) is an intersectoral measure of the severity of humanitarian conditions in a county, allowing for comparative analysis between counties and across time.

The NAF encompasses data from a variety of sources (including FSNMS, ISNA, IPC AFI and AMN, SMART surveys, JMMI, ACLED, IRNAs, REACH SMI, IOM DTM, WHO IDSR, data from Clusters) which inform the following indicators:

- Underlying vulnerability
 - Proportion of female-headed households, child-headed households and other vulnerable-group headed households
 - Proportion of IDPs and/or returnees compared to host communities
 - Longitudinal food insecurity
- Protection
 - Reports of explosive hazards, lack of access to humanitarian assistance, restriction of movement, sexual violence, family separation, HLP issues, child labour, civil documentation issues, among others
 - Armed conflict events and/or conflict-related sexual violence and/or forced recruitment of children and/or targeted killings of civilians and/or targeted property destruction
- Displacement
 - Number of displaced persons arriving and/or number of returnees returning, as significant numbers of arrivals has the potential to exacerbate food and resource access
- Disease
 - Disease outbreaks, including cholera, measles, meningitis, and malaria, among others
- Food insecurity
 - IPC AFI classifications are used for each county
- Malnutrition
 - IPC AMN classifications or SMART survey data are used to estimate crude mortality

Initial analysis is shared with NAWG members ahead of each monthly meeting and members can flag counties for discussion. During the NAWG meeting, each flagged county undergoes contextual analysis before the assignment of a final band based on needs severity.

Underlying vulnerability accounts for 30% of the overall severity score, while the first-level trigger scores (protection, displacement, disease, food insecurity and malnutrition) account for 70%.

Needs severity levels

Severity band	Indicator threshold	Severity level definitions
A	8 - 10	Extreme humanitarian conditions
B1	7 - 7.9	Severe humanitarian conditions (higher severity)
B2	6 - 6.9	Severe humanitarian conditions (lower severity)
C	4 - 5.9	Moderate humanitarian conditions
D	2 - 3.9	Stressed humanitarian conditions
E	0 - 1.9	Minor or acceptable humanitarian conditions

SOUTH SUDAN - NEEDS ANALYSIS WORKING GROUP (NAWG)

January 2025 - February 2025 Analysis

Counties facing “extreme” humanitarian conditions
Based on the backend analysis, six counties were classified as ‘Band A’, namely: **Pibor, Malakal, Renk, Tonj East, Twic, and Rubkona.**

Following in-depth discussion and contextual analysis during the NAWG meeting, Nasir was ultimately classified as exhibiting extreme humanitarian needs (Band A). Nasir was reclassified as Band A (from Band B1) due to recent reports of significant displacement in the Malow area, with an estimated 20,000 people displaced reportedly due to food shortages. This recent displacement was a critical factor considered by the NAWG, and may not have been fully captured by the backend analysis, given the proximity of the reported displacement relative to the backend analysis.

Discussion and joint analysis

- **Renk:** Flagged due to the significant influx of approximately 120,000 individuals within a span of six weeks in December-January, and because of the recent cholera outbreak. Intention surveys indicate that approximately 43% of newly arrived persons intend to remain in Renk. Market functionality in Renk has also been affected by the influx, as has the provision of basic services, like clean water and healthcare. **NAWG severity classification: A**
- **Lafon:** Flagged due reports of recent movement of cattle herders from Pibor through Lafon, presenting the possibility of inter-communal violence. Significant nutrition needs exist in Lafon, while there is limited humanitarian presence. Members flagged notable access constraints due to flooding. **NAWG severity classification: B1**
- **Gogrial West:** Flagged due to flooding, protection concerns, and measles cases reported in December. **NAWG severity classification: B1**
- **Aweil Centre:** Flagged due to riots in January which resulted in the displacement of approximately 5,000 people near Aweil Town. The market in Aweil town was reportedly looted, and prices remain high. **NAWG severity classification: B1**
- **Nasir:** Flagged due to displacement of an estimated 20,000 people in the Malow area, reportedly driven by food shortages. Partners are currently conducting an Inter-agency Rapid Needs Assessment (IRNA) to gather accurate data. **NAWG severity classification: B1, changed to A during the meeting**

- **Panyikang:** Flagged due to findings from a SMART survey conducted in September, which indicated a Crude Death Rate (CDR) of 1.53 (and 2.82 for men), which is extremely high. Panyikang is currently hosting several IDPs from Fangak county and there has been little information available since the recent flooding. One partner suggested increasing the band classification, but it was ultimately decided to keep the classification in line with the backend analysis, pending further information. **NAWG severity classification: B2**
- **Nagero:** Flagged due to high levels of displacement, of an estimated 20,000 people, from Tambura to Nagero, as well as recent violence in the area. Protection concerns were raised. **NAWG severity classification: B2**

Counties Flagged for Close Monitoring

The following counties have been flagged for close monitoring to encourage partners to gather more information and closely track the evolving situation. Partners are requested to pay close attention to these counties and share any relevant information.

- **Pibor:** The Kapoeta-Boma road blockage restricts the inflow of goods, exacerbated by insecurity on the road and unresolved issues regarding reopening. Boma market faces supply shortages, according to partners on the ground. Access to Pochalla is also limited. While the Bor – Pibor road had been functional, insecurity remains a persistent threat to access. Fighting in Gumuruk payam led to fatalities and displacement in December, and threatens access to livelihood areas, like pasture and fishing grounds.
- **Malakal:** A rapid qualitative food security assessment in December indicated extremely severe food insecurity, particularly along the west bank of the River Nile, corroborating recent IPC analysis. A concerning 10,000 people, representing 5% of the population in the assessed area, were classified in IPC AFI Phase 5 (Catastrophe) between September and November 2024, marking the first time IPC reported such conditions in Malakal.
- **Aweil North:** More information is needed, especially regarding the impact and needs of displaced populations from Sudan, as IDPs in Aweil states tend to experience protracted displacement.

- **Panyikang:** Flagged due to findings from a SMART survey conducted in September, which indicated a Crude Death Rate (CDR) of 1.53 (and 2.82 for men), which is extremely high. Panyikang is also hosting IDPs from Fangak and has limited information flow since recent flooding events, requiring closer monitoring.
- **Magwi:** Intercommunal fighting is ongoing, necessitating close monitoring to understand the evolving situation and humanitarian consequences.

Information Sharing

Partners are strongly encouraged to proactively share updates, reports, assessments, and any relevant field information throughout the month. This continuous information flow is crucial for the NAWG’s ongoing monitoring and analysis, ensuring timely and accurate reflection of the humanitarian situation and enabling effective response.

HRP 2025 Prioritization

Severity “A” Counties	HNRP Priority Rank
Pibor	1
Malakal	1
Renk	1
Tonj East	1
Twic	1
Rubkona	1

Counties Flagged for Close Monitoring	HNRP Priority Rank
Pibor	1
Malakal	1
Aweil North	2
Panyikang	2
Magwi	2